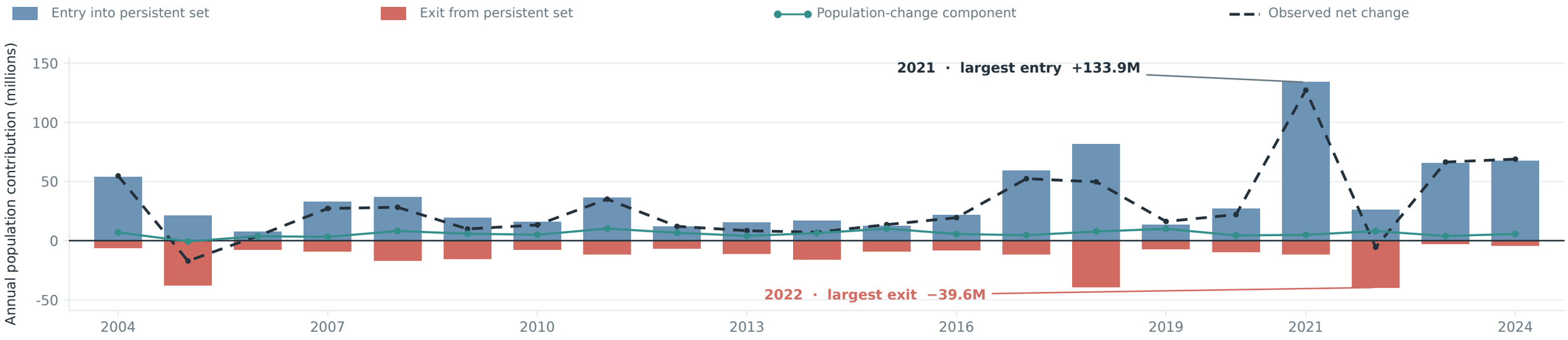
GLOBAL URBAN HEAT

Changing persistent-city membership drove most population growth

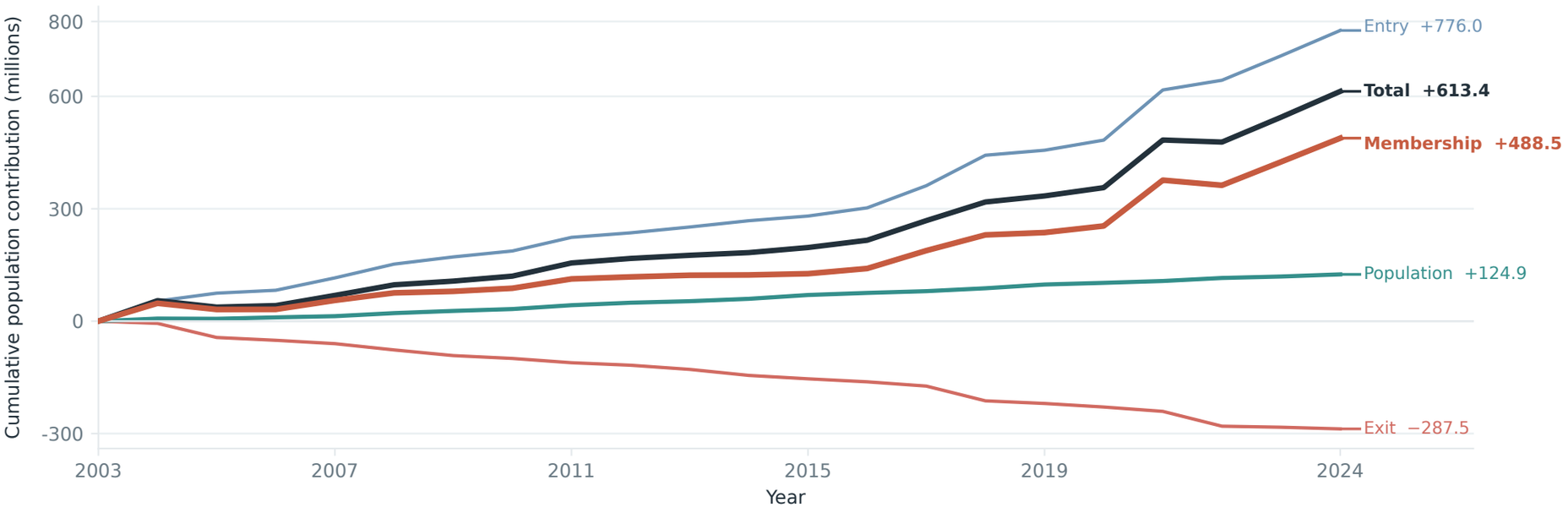
21 annual transitions / 613.4 million more people in persistent cities / 2003–2024

A Annual transitions repeatedly added and removed populations



Transition ending year. Cities entering and exiting contribute repeatedly; population changes are shown separately.

B Cumulative contributions reveal the dominant source of growth



SOURCE OF NET POPULATION INCREASE

79.6%

Persistent-city membership changes

79.6% membership 20.4%

+488.5M **+124.9M**

Total increase **+613.4 million**

Annual symmetric decomposition using 2003–2024 LandScan ambient population in fixed city boundaries. Membership-change terms include entries and exits; Population changes within cities entering or leaving persistence are weighted symmetrically between consecutive years.